

Teacher card

Explaining causes of conflict / LAUNCH_S1_W01

Outcome: Explain the causes of a twentieth century conflict.

Evidence to retain: F: book task, questioning and two exit questions.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Explain the content before starting. Offer a planned break and a factual written route. Never simulate persecution. Teacher previews any external archive page or video. The supplied four-word excerpt and paraphrase provide a non-graphic written route. The external page also contains family-loss context; preview it before projecting. Do not invent a recording date if the item page does not state one.

Access and regulation

Pre-teach terminology and model evidence use. Chunk sources and data; provide an initial frame, then reduce it. Maintain normal access arrangements. Extend by weighing limitations, alternative explanations and evidence quality. Adults support access and evidence selection without supplying answers. For sensitive material, explain content beforehand, offer a short regulated break and avoid graphic imagery, simulation or role-play.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

Use sensitive content warnings where relevant. Do not ask for family details or personal experiences.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: What was the immediate trigger for British and French declarations?

Evidence: A Europe in 1939: Nazi Germany's expansion and invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939 led Britain and France to declare war on 3 September. Longer-term conditions and leaders' choices help explain the conflict.

Think aloud: Germany's invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939.

Check: Does identifying a trigger explain every cause? No. Longer-term conditions and choices also require explanation.

Arrival answers

1. A serious struggle including war
2. A serious struggle including war
3. Germany's invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939.
4. No. Longer-term conditions and choices also require explanation.

Shared activity reasoning

1. Expansionist aims — Longer-term factor. These help explain repeated territorial demands.
2. Invasion of Poland — Immediate trigger. This preceded the declarations of war.
3. British and French declarations — Consequence. These followed on 3 September 1939.

Exit responses

What was the immediate trigger for British and French declarations? Germany's invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939.

Does identifying a trigger explain every cause? No. Longer-term conditions and choices also require explanation.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Model a causal explanation with a short source set; guide sorting of factors; independently explain supported links.

Look for

F: book task, questioning and two exit questions.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

United States Holocaust Memorial Museum introduction

<https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/introduction-to-the-holocaust>

Gerda Haas prewar community testimony <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/oral-history/gerda-haas-describes-prewar-jewish-community-life-in-ansbach>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.